



कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन

(श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)

EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUND ORGANISATION

(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India)

मुख्य कार्यालय / Head Office

भविष्य निधि भवन, 14-भिकाजी कामा प्लेस, नई दिल्ली-110 066.

Bhavishya Nidhi Bhawan, 14, Bhikaiji Cama Place, New Delhi - 110 066.

No. CSD/AG /2018

Dated: 18-01-2018

To,

All Additional Central P.F. Commissioners, Zones
All Regional P.F. Commissioner/In-Charge of ROs,

Subject: Improving responsiveness of PROs of the field offices- reg.

Sir/Madam,

Please refer to this office letter no. CSD-I/CPGRAMS/PRAGATI/2017/2007 Dated 8.12.2017 regarding timely and quality redressal of public grievances directing that all public grievances should be redressed not only within 20 days but also the quality of redressal/disposal should be high and up to the satisfaction of the aggrieved parties. Hence, every sincere effort should be made to ensure that while reviewing the pendency and disposal of grievances in your Office feedback must be obtained from the aggrieved persons through suitable mechanism on the quality of disposal/satisfaction level and the same should be analyzed regularly for ensuring further action and effecting systemic improvements.

- As part of the continuous evaluation process of grievance handling and management, it is directed to **ensure proper and effective functioning of PRO in all field offices.**

In this regard, MAP Part-I, Chap.15 specifically provides that:

"15.6The public Relations Officer should also render necessary guidance to the members/employers in completing the Forms. The P.R.O Wing should be manned by the officials who are young, energetic possessing thorough knowledge of working of the Act & Scheme and above all, the person should be patient enough to listen to the grievances of the members/employers. He should have pleasing manner and helpful attitude towards the visiting complaints. The complainants should be treated as a friend rather than unwanted persons. Considering the importance of the P.R.O wing which will mar or boost the image Of the Organisation..."

Therefore, as PRO is often; first point of contact of organisation with stakeholders; it is imperative that PRO section is well organised with neat & clean ambience having adequate amenities for visitors. The PRO section should be equipped with manpower having adequate soft skills and knowledge to deal with public.

3. It has generally been observed that non-responsiveness of PRO is a serious cause of concern and grievance among stakeholders across the country. As such it must be ensured that all visitors are attended in a courteous manner and there should be continuous availability of an official to attend phone calls properly. RPFC in-charge and ACC (Zone) shall ensure proper functioning of PRO section. It would be appropriate and proper if head of field offices interact frequently with visitors at PRO section. ACC (Zone) may also conduct surprise visits to PRO sections of sub-ordinate field offices.
4. "Help Desk" at the home page of the central EPFO website, alongwith toll free number 1800118005 will also display the telephone numbers of the PRO/general enquiry/grievance redressal cell of field offices so that members can directly contact the concerned field office for redressal of their grievances.
5. **Handling Telephone Calls :** It must be ensured that calls made to PRO/ general enquiry/grievance redressal cell of office, do not go unanswered. If the existing strength of telephone lines of PRO are found inadequate/ remain busy throughout due to continuous calls by complainant/subscribers/members/pensioners, additional lines/ phone numbers should be provided. Adequate skilled manpower should be deployed to man each such line at all times during office hours.
6. **Responding to E-Mails:** All the offices and officers are already equipped with e-mail facility with Internet Connections. Hence, all E-mails received in the offices either through E-mail Id of office or the officer concerned, should be replied promptly. Also, it must be ensured that proper details such as name, designation and contact no of the officer/official responding to e-mail are mentioned in the reply.
7. There is huge increase in the number of grievances being lodged. The reason for such increase in quantum of grievances requires to be analyzed by each of the offices and taking appropriate corrective measures. The Zonal ACCs have already been informed in this regard vide letter dated 09.01.2018 and their response is awaited. Please ensure to forward your report within a week's time.
8. RPFC In charge of Regions shall be personally responsible to ensure proper and effective functioning of PRO/Facilitation Centre of her/his office and it is reasonable that at least once in a day she/he shall visit PRO wing/Facilitation Centre at appropriate hours to interact with visitors as well as to take a stock of the facility and functioning of the officials.
9. Each of the zonal offices, sufficient number of RPFC-I have been posted. As such one of the RPFC-I at Zonal Offices be assigned duties to ensure proper monitoring of the entire grievance handling mechanism/PRO of the regional offices in the zone. He/she shall call PRO of regional offices of the zone at random hours to surprise check functioning of PRO and if any repeated non-response is observed, accountability of concerned

officials should be made and reported to ACC(Zone) in writing by such RPFC-I.

10. A report to be sent within a fortnight from the issuance of this communication informing the Head Office that each of the instructions under the instant circular has been complied with.

Yours faithfully,



(Dr. V. P. Joy)

Central Provident Fund Commissioner